

Yassine RACHIDY

PhD Candidate | LLM Alignment

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ABOUT

PhD candidate at UM6P working on LLM robustness and alignment. Currently focusing on mechanistic interpretability of LLM safety mechanisms and on translating those insights into more reliable defenses.

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate 2024 – Present
AI Movement, University Mohammed VI Polytechnic (UM6P) Rabat, Morocco

- Supervised by Prof. Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni and Dr. Youssef Hmamouche
- Research Focus: AI Alignment, Mechanistic Interpretability, LLM Reasoning, and Robustness.

Pre-doctoral Student 2023 – 2024
AI Movement, University Mohammed VI Polytechnic (UM6P) Rabat, Morocco

MEng in Data & Software Engineering 2023
National Institute of Statistics and Applied Economics (INSEA) Rabat, Morocco

PUBLICATIONS

Strategic Deflection: Defending LLMs from Logit Manipulation 2026
Computational Linguistics

- Introduced a novel defense mechanism against jailbreaking attacks that strategically redirects harmful queries when refusals fail, demonstrating significant reduction in Attack Success Rate (ASR) while maintaining performance on benign tasks.
- Mechanistically characterized the defense via token-level entropy dynamics and latent trajectory probing, confirming deflection operates representationally rather than through surface-level lexical patterns.

Domain Adaptive Document Reranking for Retrieval Augmented Generation 2025
37th International Conference on Tools with Artificial Intelligence (ICTAI)

- Engineered a novel Mixture of Experts (MoE) reranker architecture to efficiently handle multi-domain adaptability, achieving superior performance over LLM-based and commercial models without the cost of deploying multiple specialized models.

SKILLS

Languages
English (Professional), French (Professional), Arabic (Native)

Technical Skills
LLM Safety & Alignment (preference optimization, adversarial robustness, jailbreak attack design and evaluation) · Mechanistic Interpretability (sparse autoencoders, causal intervention, linear probing, residual stream analysis) · ML Engineering.